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Man held in alleged 'reign of terror'

Prosecutors: SWAT shooting suspect fell into state of paranoia

By Evgenia Anastasakos, Sam Charles, Caroline Kubzansky and Deanese Williams-Harris
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Daniel Aguirre became increasingly paranoid after losing his job as a forklift operator, prosecutors said. He had stopped sleeping, installed padlocks on the doors of his apartment and was drinking eight to ten energy drinks per day.

On Monday, a fight with his longtime partner turned into an hourslong standoff that left both a woman and a SWAT officer injured, with Aguirre facing nearly a dozen felony charges.

Police and Cook County state's attorney's office records show Aguirre, 42, was charged with three counts of attempted murder, two counts of aggravated discharge of a firearm toward a police officer and other charges.

He appeared in Cook County court Wednesday where a judge ordered him detained while awaiting trial, after prosecutors alleged how domestic violence led to a close call for a Chicago cop.

Aguirre shot a 67-year-old woman at a home in the 4600 block of North Springfield Avenue before barricading himself inside with another woman and a 14-year-old girl, authorities said.

Aguirre lives at that address in a second-floor apartment with his longtime partner and their 14-year-old daughter, according to a proffer presented Wednesday by Cook County prosecutors. The partner's mother and sister also live in the building.

Aguirre had accused his partner of poisoning him before beginning his "reign of terror" on Monday morning, Assistant State's Attorney Mike Pekara said at the detention hearing.

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WAR IN IRAN

Trump issues dire threat

President promises to destroy power plant or bridge each time Tehran strikes ship in strait

By Jon Gambrell and Collin Binkley
ASSOCIATED PRESS

DUBAI, United Arab Emirates — The U.S. military announced Wednesday that it was conducting a 12th night of strikes against Iran as both sides increasingly targeted civilian infrastructure.

U.S. Central Command once again said the attacks were designed to "further degrade Iran's ability to threaten civilian mariners and commercial vessels transiting regional waters," as the Americans push to regain control over the Strait of Hormuz and restore the flow of international shipping.

President Donald Trump warned earlier Wednesday that the U.S. will destroy one bridge or power plant each time Iran shoots at a ship in the strait.

"From this point forward, any time the Islamic Republic of Iran shoots at a ship in the Strait of Hormuz, whether it be by Missile, Rocket, Drone, or any other device or weapon, the United States will bomb and destroy ONE BRIDGE OR POWER PLANT," Trump wrote on social media.

The latest campaign of American airstrikes is occurring even as diplomatic efforts show little public sign of progress and officials on both sides have dug in on the dispute over the crucial waterway for global energy that remains largely closed because of Iranian attacks. The unpopular war threatens further worldwide economic disruption and sending fuel prices up ahead of midterm U.S. elections

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KENNY HOLSTON/THE NEW YORK TIMES

A farewell for 'great patriots'

President Donald Trump on Wednesday honored the lives of four U.S. service members who were killed in the Middle East and returned to their families at an air force base in Delaware. The president saluted as four transfer cases carrying the service members' remains were escorted off an airplane during the transfer. His message to the families, he said, was, "We love you. We love your child." **Nation & World, Page B5**

Pritzker: Be transparent on Benton allegations

By Jeremy Gorner and Rick Pearson
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Gov. JB Pritzker on Wednesday called on Illinois House Speaker Emanuel "Chris" Welch to come clean to the public about his office's handling of sexual harassment allegations made three years ago against now-former state Rep. Harry Benton, as the House Democratic Women's Caucus criticized Welch's handling of the case as "insufficient."

The governor declined to say whether he still supported Welch as House speaker in light of a Tribune investigation that raised questions about how the Hillside Democrat's office handled the 2023 allegations by a young female staffer. Those claims surfaced after



Gov. JB Pritzker answers reporters' questions at the Global Quantum Forum in Chicago on Wednesday. **ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

at least one other person came forward this year with more recent harassment allegations against Benton, a Democrat from Plainfield, sparking discipline from Welch and an investigation by the legislative inspector general.

But Pritzker did call on Welch to be open about what his office knew about Benton's behavior and when. So far, Welch's office has defended its handling of the

2023 case, telling the Tribune it acted "promptly" and said "appropriate action was taken" — though prepared statements from his office did not specify what, if any, disciplinary action occurred against Benton three years ago.

"People should be held to a very high standard. If you are going to serve in public office, elected office

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Industry group sues over state's cryptocurrency tax

By Dan Petrella
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

A first-in-the-nation tax on cryptocurrencies and other digital assets that Gov. JB Pritzker signed last month is facing a legal challenge from an industry association that argues the law is unconstitutional because it singles out certain financial instruments based on how their transactions are recorded.

Democrats in the General Assembly approved the so-called cryptocurrency tax during legislative overtime last month as part

of their effort to balance a nearly \$56 billion spending plan for the budget year that began July 1. The tax, which takes effect Jan. 1, is expected to generate \$60 million in new revenue to help support day-to-day operations.

In an email newsletter in early June, House Speaker Emanuel "Chris" Welch, a Hillside Democrat, touted the tax as part of an election-year affordability agenda that included "closing corporate loopholes and making big tech companies and crypto billionaires

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JOHN J. KIM/TRIBUNE

INSIDE

How Crow-Armstrong refined his approach

Cubs All-Star outfielder Pete Crow-Armstrong's improved plate discipline has continued into the second half, and an adjustment made in May has propelled increased production against lefties. **Sports**

REFERENDUM RUCKUS: Mayor's foes ram through series of ballot questions, the latest front in City Hall fight. **Chicagoland, Page A5**

"The speaker has a responsibility to be utterly and completely transparent about the situation to make sure that he is letting the public know, as well as, in particular, his members know exactly what happened, and to the extent that he made mistakes, to own up to those mistakes."

GOV. JB PRITZKER, on the handling of allegations against ex-state Rep. Harry Benton

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